done, doing calculations and constructing new models of particles and fields.

Everett, of course, left academia without even trying to become a physics professor. David Bohm, who had studied and worked under Robert Oppenheimer in the 1940s, proposed an ingenious way of using hidden variables to address the measurement problem. But after a seminar in which another physicist explained Bohm's ideas, Oppenheimer scoffed out loud, "If we cannot disprove Bohm, then we must agree to ignore him." John Bell, who did more than anyone to illuminate the apparently nonlocal nature of quantum entanglement, purposefully hid his work on this subject from his colleagues at CERN, to whom he appeared as a relatively conventional particle theorist. Hans Dieter Zeh, who pioneered the concept of decoherence as a young researcher in the 1970s, was warned by his mentor that working on this subject would destroy his academic career. Indeed, he found it very difficult to publish his early papers, being told by journal referees that "the paper is completely senseless" and "quantum theory does not apply to macroscopic objects." Dutch physicist Samuel Goudsmit, serving as the editor of *Physical Review*, put out a memo in 1973 explicitly banning the journal from even considering papers on quantum foundations unless they made new experimental predictions. (Had that policy been in place earlier, the journal would have had to reject the Einstein-Podolsky-Rosen paper, as well as Bohr's reply.)

Yet, as these very stories make clear, despite a variety of hurdles put up in their way, a subset of physicists and philosophers nevertheless persevered in the effort to better understand the nature of quantum reality. The Many-Worlds theory, especially once the process of wave-function branching has been illuminated by decoherence, is one promising approach to answering the puzzles raised by the measurement problem. But there are others worth considering. They are worthwhile both because they might actually be right (which is always the best reason) and also because comparing the very different ways in which they work helps us to better appreciate quantum mechanics, no matter what our personal favorite approach happens to be.

An impressive number of alternative formulations of quantum theory have been proposed over the years. (The relevant Wikipedia article lists sixteen "interpretations" explicitly, along with a category for "other.") Here we'll consider three basic competitors to the Everett approach: dynamical collapse, hidden variables, and epistemic theories. While far from